



Boo-Man's thoughts

"Realme 11x 5G, a mixed bag in the smartphone world. Some decent camera tricks, but the design is polarizing, performance is a rollercoaster, and the battery, well, it's not gonna win any marathons. Get ready for a bumpy ride!"

feels smooth with 120 Hz active minus the occasional stutters we spoke about. We really feel that there are better phones at the same price for gaming enthusiasts though.

Moving on to software, the Realme 11x 5G will get 2 years of OS updates and 3 years of security updates, which is standard for the company. As usual, Realme UI 4.0 is still brimming with bloatware and preinstalled third-party applications. Many of these can be uninstalled, but many can't. The UI has a lot of features, but it is let down by the excessive bloatware.

CAMERAS

According to me, the camera is the highlight of the Realme 11x 5G. Everything so far, including the performance, display, and build, has been pretty average, but the primary camera is where Realme has put in that extra work. The Realme 11x 5G comes packing a 64 MP primary camera with f/1.79 aperture and a nominal 2 MP portrait lens. The 2 MP lens isn't worthy of a lot of acclaim since its function could be achieved by software as well, but the 64 MP primary camera stands out.

At this price, you get some crisp and detailed shots with good dynamic range and colour. There's very little softness in the pictures and even close-up pictures look brilliant with great natural depth of field. The 64 MP lens manages to capture most scenes accurately, without blowing

out the colours out of proportion by excessively saturating them.

Portrait images look decent as well. I did find a bit of softness creep in here on subjects' faces, but the edge detection is decent and colours look good in ideal lighting.

What's the most impressive is the 2x in-sensor zoom (or near lossless zoom). It gives users the benefit of having telephoto-like functionality without actually having a physical telephoto sensor. The 2x zoomed shots are taken by cropping into the 64 MP shots – since it has a lot of pixels, it can crop in safely without sacrificing much detail. The resulting images look sharp, detailed, and crisp. The 8 MP selfie camera performs as expected; the colours look nice – a tad saturated, but the detail is a bit washed out. Portrait selfies are usable if clicked in good lighting as well.

Low-light images from the main camera have some noise, but the detail is well-retained for the price. The colours are slightly washed out though. Selfie photos have a lot of noise in low light.

BATTERY LIFE

The Realme 11x 5G houses a 5,000 mAh battery which keeps the lights on. However, it doesn't do so for as long as I expected. The battery life of the Realme 11x 5G is strictly mediocre. In our routine 4K video loop test, where we play a video at full brightness on VLC,

the phone lasted merely 9 hours and 6 minutes, which is much lower than the competition. For example, the Samsung Galaxy M34 5G lasted a whopping 21.5 hours in the same test. So, if battery life is your main concern, give this one a skip since it doesn't match its competitors. Even when playing COD: Mobile, the phone drained a lot of battery than others at the same price. It lost 7 per cent of its battery in just 15 minutes (from 80 to 73 per cent), which is disappointing.

Charging speeds are quite decent though. You get 33 W SUPERVOOC wired charging which topped up our review unit from zero to full in just 1 hour and 14 minutes.

VERDICT

Buy the Realme 11x 5G for its impressive and reliable camera. The 64 MP camera outshines most of its similarly-priced competitors, and the 2x in-sensor, near-lossless zoom opens up avenues for some great shots. However, if you value battery life or display, I would recommend other options instead. For great battery life and display, my primary recommendation would be the Samsung Galaxy M34 instead, since it lasts twice as long and has a solid Super AMOLED display. And for faster gaming performance, the iQOO Z7 5G would be your best bet. The Realme 11x 5G shines in one area – the camera. However, given the more well-rounded phones in this price range, it would not be my number one choice. Still, if cameras are your only concern, this is one of the best, if not the best.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 6100+ 5G | GPU: Mali-G57 MC2 | RAM: 6/8 GB | Internal storage: 128 GB | Process technology: 6 nm | Cameras (rear): 64 MP + 2 MP | Selfie camera: 8 MP | Display: 6.72-inch Full HD+ IPS LCD | Display refresh rate: 120 Hz | Battery capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 33 W SUPERVOOC | Thickness: 7.89 mm | Weight: 190 g | OS: Android 13, Realme UI 4.0

CONTACT

Company: Realme | Phone: 1800 102 2777 | Email: NA | Website: <https://www.realme.com/in/>